am able to give a more complete reading of the legends on both sides from a coin in my own collection—

Obv.—Sri Mahendra Sinha Parâkrama.
Rev.—Kumara Gupta * *—

"In 1874 a pot of old rupees was found in Mahâsthân itself by a labourer, who was digging a ditch in a *pân* garden." One of these coins belonged to Ilias Shâh, and the others to Mahmud I. I also obtained three of these rupees found in Mahâsthân. One of them belonged to Jalâl-uddin Muhammad, and the other two to Mahmud I. One of them is dated in A.H. 846, and the other in A.H. 848. The first coin is in very fine order.

27.—PAHARPUR.

A brief notice of the great mound of Pahârpur has been given by Buchanan, and his opinion that it was a Buddhist stûpa has been adopted by Mr. Westmacott[1]. The mound had also been described to me by some of the railway officers as being a solid mass of bricks, and they had no doubt inspected it carefully with an eye to railway ballast, as it is only 4 miles to the west of the Darjîling Railway, opposite Jamâlganj. It stands 29 miles to the west of Mahâsthân, and 20 miles to the east of Patnitolah on the Atreyi River. Buchanan estimates the height of the mound rather vaguely at "from 100 to 150 feet;" but according to my measurement it is not more than 80 feet above the country, and only 70 feet above the level of its own court-yard. On the south is the good-sized village of Pahârpur, or "Hill-town," which derives its name from the mound. To the north-west is the small village of *Gwâl Bhita,* which is erroneously printed in Buchanan's account as *Gopal Chitar Pahar. Gwâl Bhita* means simply the cow-herd's mound, *Gwâla* being the contraction of *go-wâla,* or "cow-keeper." Buchanan always spells this word as *goyâl,* but the common pronunciation is better represented in the name of *Goâlpâra* in Assam.

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[1] Buchanan, Eastern India, Vol. II., p. 669, and Westmacott, in Bengal Asiatic Society's Journal, Vol. XLIII, p. 189.

The great mound stands in the middle of a large enclosure, about 1,500 feet square outside, formed by a massive earthen embankment, about 150 feet broad on the east side, and not more than 100 feet on the other three sides. I forced my way on to the top of the southern embankment on an elephant; and in the same way I was able to examine several parts of the broad eastern embankment, which is everywhere covered with bricks, and the remains of walls. On the low ground inside the enclosure the jungle was so high and so dense that it was quite impenetrable to a man. I forced my way through on an elephant to the foot of the mound, and ascending a short distance on the south-east side to a small clear spot, I was able to examine the site at leisure. With the exception of a few tanks, there was nothing to be seen but thick jungle. On the slope we found several broken terra-cotta alto-relievos and pieces of carved brick. A party of coolies was then set to work to clear the jungle on all the slopes of the mound, and to make a rough path up to the top. In cutting the jungle two leopards were disturbed, but they slunk away to the opposite side, where they were seen again on the following day.

I had intended making some extensive excavations in the mound, and I had brought some skilled labourers with me for this very purpose, but on my return to my tent I found an agent from the zamindar owner of the land, Raja Kishen Chandar Rai, of Bolihâr, 9 miles to the south, who prohibited all excavations. I then set all the men to work to clear the jungle, and by the evening I got a pretty fair view of the mass of the mound, and was also able to climb to the top of it. Here I made a few superficial excavations, which showed that the upper part of the building was a square tower of 22 feet side, with a projection in the middle of each face. A few feet lower down the side was 28 feet, below which the wall could not be traced, as the slope was too steep for the workmen to find a footing. The slope of this upper part was 3 inches in ten courses of bricks, equal to 30 inches in height, or just 1 in 10. On the east side, however, from about half down the slope is long and gentle. I conclude therefore that the mound is the ruin of a large Brahmanical temple, with its entrance to the east, and its highest point, the spire covering the sanctum, on the west. The whole length of the ruin from west to east is about 200 feet, the highest point being 50 feet from the western base and 150 feet from the eastern base. There was ample room therefore for the usual *Mahâ-mandapa*, or assembly hall, between the sanctum and the entrance.

I have ventured to call the temple a Brahmanical one, because one of the terra-cotta sculptures represented the skeleton goddess Kâli. The other terra-cotta figures give no indication of the nature of the building. They are all 14 inches in height by 10 in breadth. The best preserved specimen is shown in the accompanying plate[1]. It is apparently only a fancy figure representing a man sitting in an uneasy-looking position, with both arms raised. A third figure has the right hand raised and the left hand resting on the hip. A fourth figure is accompanied by a monkey. A fifth terra-cotta panel of smaller size, 10 inches by 8, was filled with an ornamental circle, while a sixth of still smaller size, or 6 inches by 6, was decorated with some neatly designed foliage. All of these must have belonged to the long lines of friezes with which all the finer Hindu temples are decorated. There were also numerous pieces of moulded and carved bricks, which formed the cornices and smaller bands of ornament.

On the very top of the mound a considerable number of wedge-shaped bricks were found, the smaller ones being ornamented at the broad or outer end. The largest of these bricks was 15½ inches in length by 10⅞ inches at the broad end, and 8⅔ inches at the narrow end. Others were only 11⅔ inches in length by 9 inches at the broad end, and 8 at the narrow end. From the position in which these wedge bricks were found, it is clear that they must have belonged to the *Kalas*, or pinnacle of the temple, which is always of a circular shape. I made out from an examination of the different sized pieces that the neck of the *Kalas* must have been about 9 feet in diameter, gradually swelling to about 12 feet by successive projections of the upper courses. As the top of the

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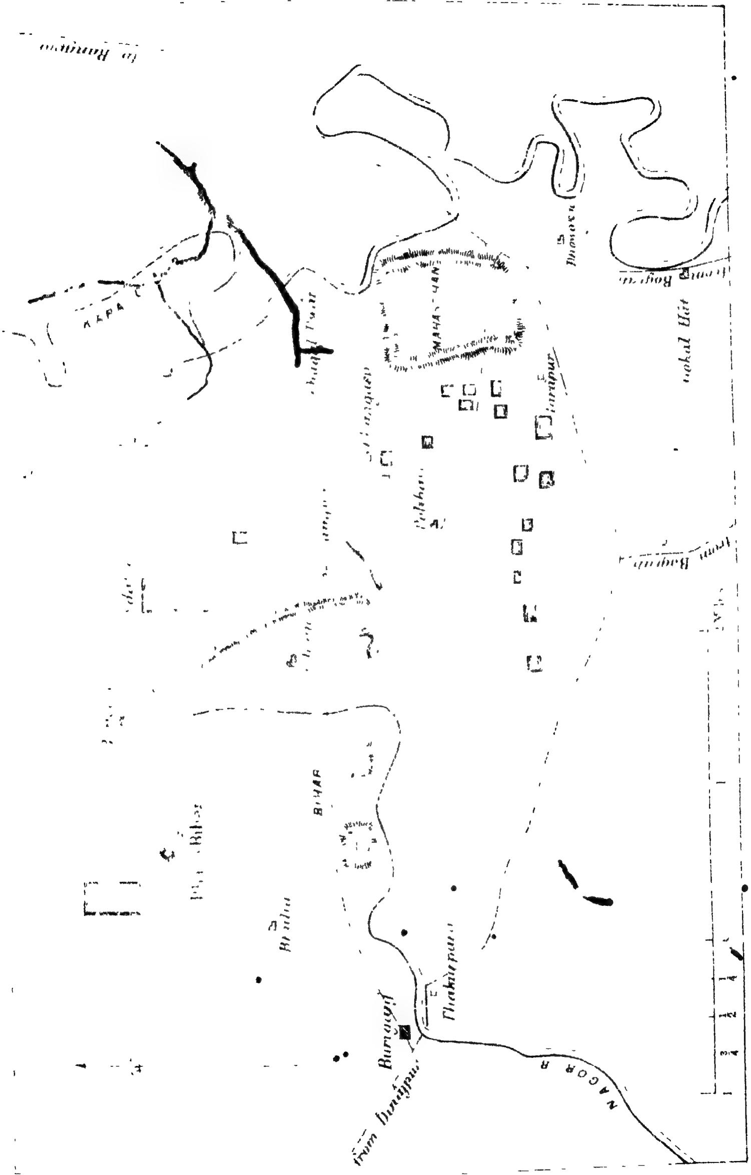
[1] See Plate XXXI.

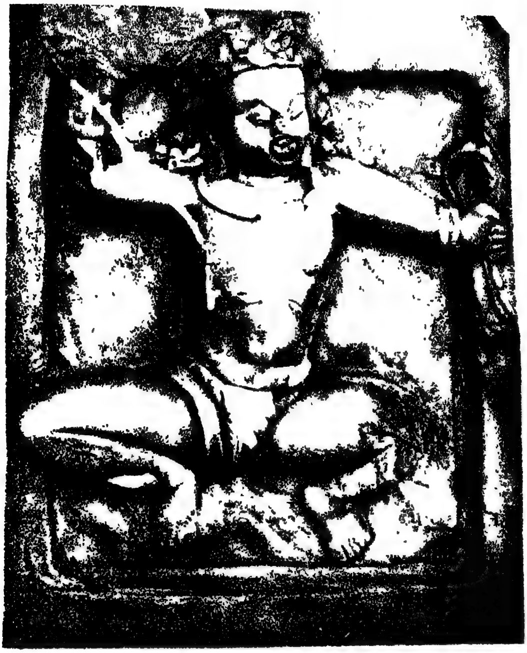
MAHASTHAN.



A. Cunningham del.

Lithographed [illegible] Calcutta [illegible] 1882

PAHARPUR.



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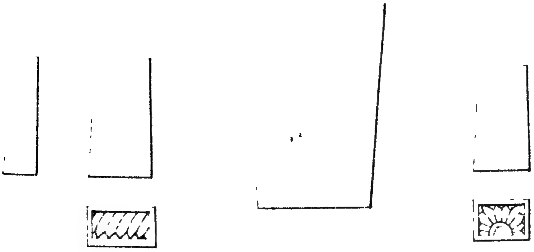

Lithographed at the Surveyor General's Office Calcutta, September 1882